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ON THE STUMP

Democrats, Frank would like a word with you

In perhaps parting advice, he tells liberals to fervently reject toxic leftist positions

By Bryan Marquard
GLOBE STAFF

“You know, I’ve never believed in an afterlife,” Barney Frank said by phone from his Ogunquit, Maine, home Sunday. “I’ve always believed that dead is dead.”

Frank is still very much alive, however, and while in hospice care with congestive heart failure, the famously outspoken former congressman is devoting much of his remaining time to shaping his political afterlife in a series of media interviews in hopes that his stern advice will buoy the Democratic Party in the upcoming midterm elections this fall and in the 2028 presidential election.

Though the ticking clock of failing health is ever present, his doctors aren’t predicting how much time he has left.

“They have no idea,” he said before adding one of his trademark asides: “Look, I’m not buying any New Year’s cards.”

In an interview partly for his Boston Globe obit, which he’ll never read, Frank, 86, focused mostly on advice for his party’s candidates, drawing from experiences dating back to his beginnings as a state representative more than 50 years ago and his 32 years in the US House of Representatives.

Frank left Congress in 2013.

He believes past approaches he had taken to advocating for liberal causes can inform the cam-

FRANK, Page A6



PETE MAROVICH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE FILE

Barney Frank hopes part of his political legacy will be helping Democrats win in 2028.

Endorsements return Biden to political arena

Unclear how backing will help Koh in primary race

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

Former president Joe Biden is wading into Massachusetts politics, endorsing his former aide, Dan Koh, in the Sixth Congressional District’s crowded Democratic primary and testing what influence — good or bad — his involvement has in his own party’s contests.

In a video recording of a phone call between Koh and Biden released Monday by Koh’s campaign, Biden praised Koh’s time in his administration, calling him a “tough fighter for standing up for people in the country.”

“You will be one heck of a congressman,” Biden says in the video. “Everything you and I fought for, everything we did to help ordinary people, is in jeopardy now in this [Trump] administration, so we gotta get you elected.”

“And by the way,” he adds, “I’ll come and campaign for you if you want me to.”

Biden’s support for Koh, who served in the former president’s administration for nearly all of Biden’s tenure, represents one of his first forays back into campaigns after a tumultuous exit from his 2024 campaign preceded his party’s total loss

BIDEN, Page A5

Bracing for abortion pill fight

Uncertainty, confusion follow rulings by courts over mailing of mifepristone

By Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

A sweeping federal appeals court ruling that threatened to sharply restrict access to the abortion pill mifepristone has been put on hold — at least for now — by the US Supreme Court. But the legal maneuvering is creating uncertainty for providers in Massachusetts, a national hub for abortion care that relies heavily on mailing the medi-

cation to patients.

“It’s been a busy 36 hours,” said Dr. Angel Foster, a physician with Cambridge Reproductive Health Consultants, a nonprofit that serves a significant number of telehealth patients through the Massachusetts Medication Abortion Access Project.

“Hundreds of patients are calling us confused, trying to make sense of the headlines,” Foster added. “They ask if they can take pills

that were already sent to them in the mail, can they still get ones that were just prescribed to them last week, why is this happening?”

On Monday, Justice Samuel Alito issued a temporary order allowing patients to continue receiving mifepristone through telehealth, pharmacies, and the mail, pausing a lower court decision that had required the drug to be dispensed only in person at clinics.

The high court’s intervention came just days after a three-judge panel of the US Court of Appeals for the Fifth Circuit ruled that mailing

the medication violated federal law, siding with Louisiana officials who argued the policy undermined the state’s near-total abortion ban.

The Supreme Court’s order is set to last at least through May 11 as justices consider emergency appeals from drug manufacturers. For now, it’s a key method of abortion access used by millions of patients nationwide, many of which are issued in Massachusetts.

State data show terminations using medication have more than doubled in recent years due to re-

MIFEPRISTONE, Page A6



PHOTOS BY STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF

A FINAL SALUTE, 251 YEARS LATER

Revolutionary reenactors held a solemn ceremony recently to symbolically restore 12 Groton Minutemen to the land from which they came. The soldiers died at the Battle of Bunker Hill and were buried in a mass grave by the British. Historian Don Black (top) filled in a hole where he placed soil taken from Bunker Hill. At right, Eleanor Gavazzi and Captain John Greenwood shared a solemn moment at the Old Burying Ground. **As I See It, B1.**



Yo-yo prices vex gas station owners

Market volatility turns their work into costly guessing game

By Truman Dickerson, Bryan Hecht, and Hannah Goeke
GLOBE CORRESPONDENTS

That pain at the pump? It afflicts more than motorists. Gas station owners say spiraling, unpredictable prices are battering their bottom lines.

“The simple fact is that when gas prices go up, all of us are suffering, whether you are a single store like me or a chain of 80 or 100 stores,” said Alex Weatherall, the owner of Sherborn Market and Fuel.

With the Strait of Hormuz remaining closed to most traffic, gas prices rose to a national average of over \$4 a gallon last month, a rarity in American history.

“I’m not making ... money right

GAS STATIONS, Page A7



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF FILE

Gas prices can vary drastically in a matter of minutes for owners.

The Back Bay or Back Bay? Definitely yes.

By Camilo Fonseca
GLOBE STAFF

Here’s a trick question: What’s one thing the Back Bay, the Fenway, and the Seaport all have in common?

Sure, upscale apartments and sky-high rental prices. But they also share something more basic, a simple, three-letter word: “the.”

Or, perhaps, none of them do.

When it comes to Boston neighborhoods, using the definite article is far from definitive. For some, adding a “the” before the neighborhood name is only natural, a nod to its unique character and historical identity. It’s always “the” North End. “The” South End. God forbid you drop the “the” from the West End. Someone will want a word.

But bump into someone on the street, and you might well hear them dropping the “the.” I live in Fenway. They work in Back Bay. Let’s grab a drink in Seaport.

“It’s just Back Bay,” Marianne

BACK BAY, Page A7

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Governor Maura Healey, urging lawmakers to make streets safer, proposed a set of rules to rein in those riders who speed and ignore laws while riding e-bikes, mopeds, and scooters. B1.

A cruise ship remained stranded

ed off Cape Verde in the Atlantic Ocean after three passengers died and at least three other people were seriously sickened in a suspected outbreak of a rare hantavirus. **A4.**

It will be a critical off-season for the Boston Celtics. **C1.**



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El día del sol

Tuesday: Warmer, breezy. High 74-79, low 56-61.

Wednesday: Showers later. High 64-64, low 54-59.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.** Obituaries, **C9.**